

Week 10

Project Closure & Handover

COS40006 Computing Technology Project B

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COS40006 Computing Technology Project B

- 01** Scrum Revisited
- 02** Scrum Master
- 03** Code of Conduct
- 04** Employability
- 05** Resume & Interview Prep
- 06** Transition to Employment

- 07** CapEx
- 08** ITIL Process
- 09** Ethical AI
- 10** Project Closure & Handover
- 11** HDR Pathway
- 12** Workplace Safety

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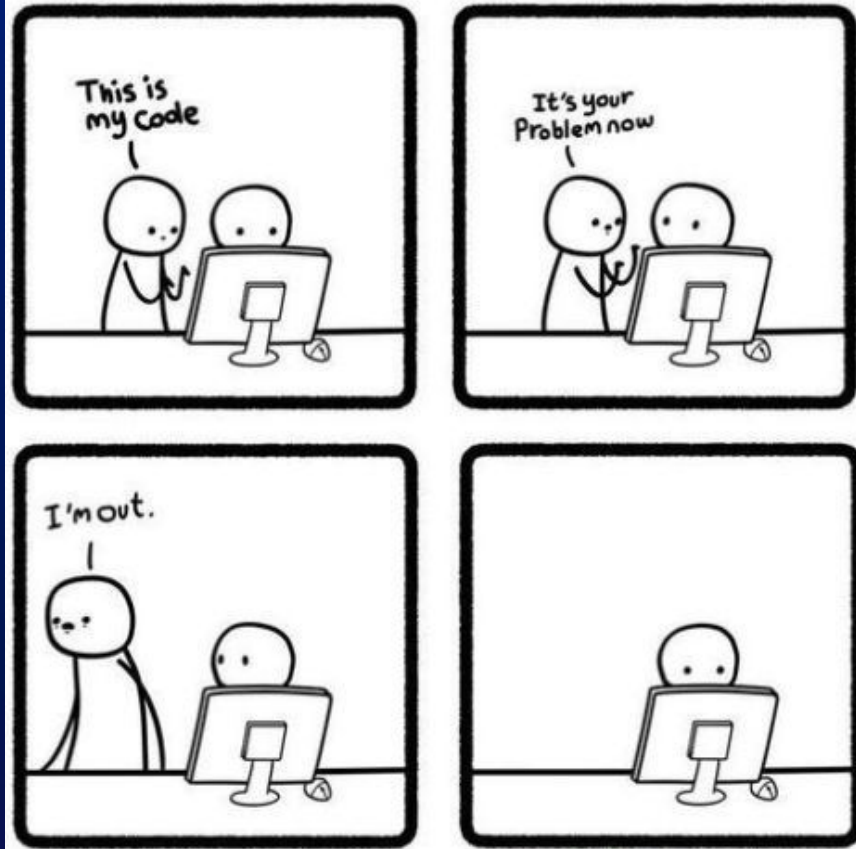
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What is

“Handover”



the Handover

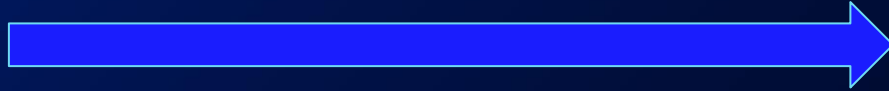


“Handover”

The structured transfer of project deliverables, documentation, and responsibility from the project team to the client or operations team for ongoing use and maintenance.

“Handover”

You,
The dev team



Client /
Operations
Team

Transfer of:

- Project deliverables
- Documentation
- Responsibility



What is

“Closure”

“Closure”

The formal process of finalizing all project activities, obtaining stakeholder acceptance, releasing resources, and documenting lessons learned to conclude the project lifecycle.

Introduction to Project Closure & Handover

- **Closure** = Formal completion of project activities.
- **Handover** = Transition of deliverables, documentation, and responsibility to client/operations team.

Why it matters:

- Ensures project value is realized.
- Avoids “orphaned” systems/products.
- Critical for career reputation → sloppy closure = poor credibility.
- PMI PMBOK (7th Ed) reference: Closure is part of the Project Management Lifecycle.

Key Objectives of Project Closure

1. Validate deliverables against acceptance criteria (scope baseline).
2. Obtain formal sign-off from client/sponsor.
3. Ensure knowledge transfer to operations/maintenance teams.
4. Release project resources (people, budget, tools).
5. Archive documentation for audits, future learning.
6. Measure project outcomes vs. original business case.

Essential Deliverables at Closure

1. Technical Deliverables: Source code, configuration files, deployment scripts, system architecture diagrams.
2. Project Documentation: Requirements specs, design docs, test cases/results, risk logs, change requests.
3. Knowledge Transfer: User manuals, training slides, walkthrough videos, Q&A sessions.
4. Contracts & Finance: Final invoices, vendor payments, license renewals.
5. Lessons Learned Report.

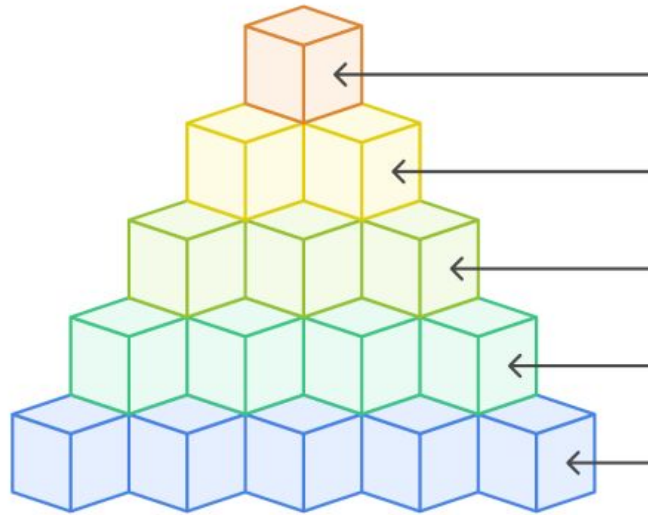
Essential Deliverables at Closure

	Internal	External
Process		
Product		

Essential Deliverables at Closure

Internal	External
Process	
Product	

Project Deliverable Creation Pyramid



Essential Deliverables at Closure

Technical Deliverables



- Source code repositories, APIs, deployment pipelines.
- Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) scripts (e.g., Terraform, Ansible).
- Architecture diagrams (system, data flow, integration).
- Purpose: ensures reproducibility and maintainability.

Project Documentation



- Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) → maps features to original requirements.
- Design documentation → UML diagrams, ER models.
- Test artefacts → unit/integration test results, UAT sign-off reports.
- Change requests + impact assessments.
- Purpose: audit trail + continuity for future enhancements.

Knowledge Transfer



- User manuals (end-user instructions).
- Administrator guides (system configs, backup/restore).
- "Day 2" operational documentation → monitoring, escalation.
- Recorded training/walkthrough sessions.
- Purpose: enables stakeholders and support staff to run the system independently.

Lessons Learned Report



- Structured retrospective (e.g., Start / Stop / Continue).
- Root cause analysis for issues (5 Whys, Fishbone Diagram).
- Successes worth replicating in future projects.
- Purpose: builds organizational/project team maturity.



Common Mistakes [To Avoid]

Closure Checklist (Do's & Don'ts)

✓ Do's:

- Cross-check deliverables against backlog/scope.
- Validate user acceptance testing (UAT) completion.
- Conduct formal project retrospective.
- Verify all risks/issues are closed or transferred.

Closure Checklist (Do's & Don'ts)

✗ Don'ts:

- Don't assume **verbal** agreement = sign-off.
- Don't skip documentation “because deadlines are over.”
- Don't ignore leftover technical debt — record it for handover.

Handover Best Practices

1. Use structured templates (Handover Document, Runbook).
2. Involve operations/maintenance teams early, not just at the end.
3. Run **joint walkthrough** sessions with stakeholders.
4. Provide “post-go-live support” period (warranty/support phase).
5. Confirm that SLAs (service level agreements) are clear and agreed upon.

Industry-Recognized Runbooks / Templates

Project Management Templates

← [Project management hub](#)

Project management templates

- [Project initiation templates](#)

[Project execution templates](#)

[Project monitoring templates](#)

[Project closure templates](#)

[Product & software team templates](#)

[Marketing team templates](#)

[IT team templates](#)

[HR team templates](#)

[Sales team templates](#)

Project initiation templates

This stage is all about stepping back and looking at the project from a broader perspective. Rather than diving headfirst into timelines and action items, the focus here is on evaluating the project's value and potential. Below, you'll find a set of templates to help guide you through the initiation phase and set your project up for success.

Roles and responsibilities template

Clearly define team roles and responsibilities to enhance collaboration.

[Learn more →](#)

Top-level planning template

Oversee high-level project planning and management with this template.

[Learn more →](#)

OKRs template

Align teams and achieve goals with structured OKR templates.

[Learn more →](#)

Annual Plan One-Pager Template

Summarize your annual plan on a concise one-pager for easy reference.

Prioritization matrix template

Prioritize projects effectively with the prioritization matrix template.

SMART goals template

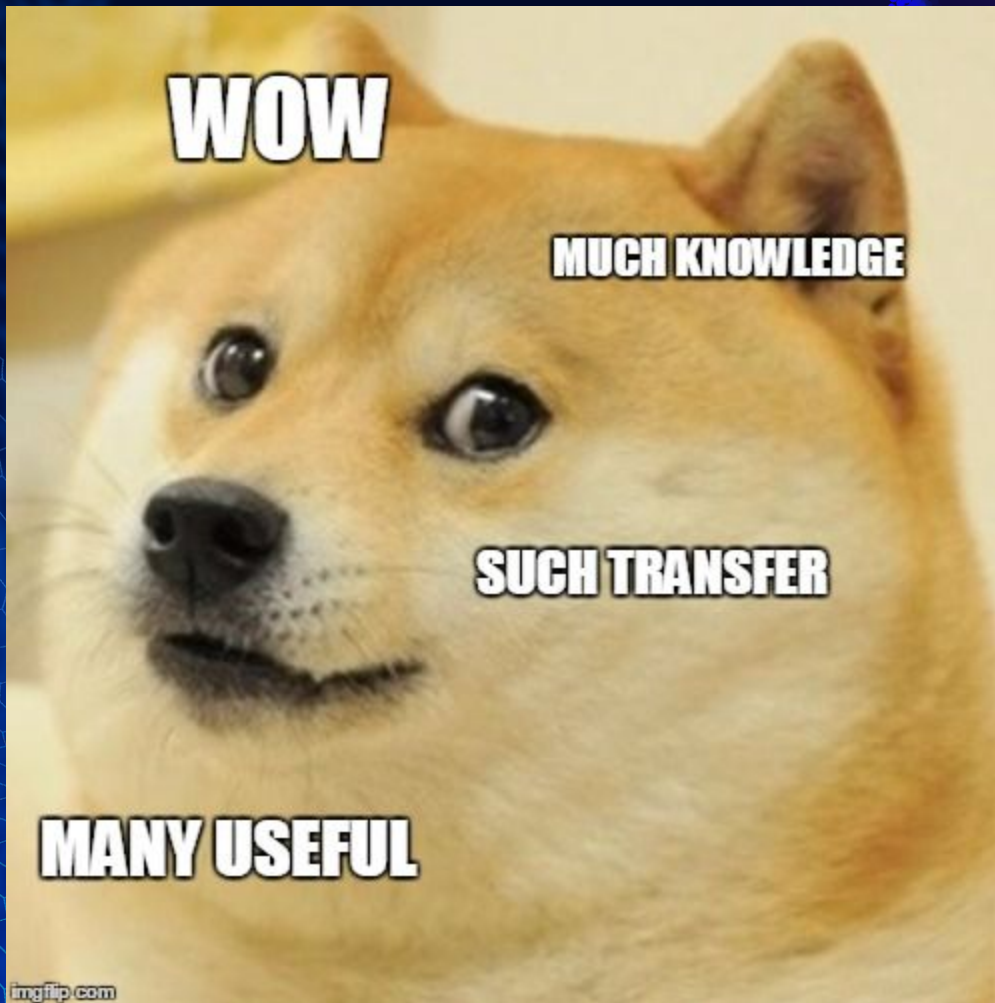
Craft specific, measurable goals with the SMART Goals template.



Transition & Knowledge Transfer

**dev who is leaving the company
in a week doing knowledge transfer**





Do's:

- Prioritize critical knowledge (maintenance procedures, failure recovery).
- Ensure non-technical staff (end-users, business users) also understand workflows.

Transition & Knowledge Transfer

Common Techniques:

- Shadowing → Ops team observes project team.
- Reverse Shadowing → Project team observes ops team.

/or/

- Training workshops, recorded demos, FAQs.
- Tools to support: Confluence, GitHub Wiki, SharePoint.

“Shadowing”

What is

“Shadowing”

A learning opportunity where you follow someone and watch them perform their job, offering a firsthand look at the role and its environment.

“Shadowing”

One person (observer) watches another perform tasks, with minimal intervention.

Purpose = learning the workflow.

“Thinking Out Loud”

The expert verbalizes their reasoning while performing tasks



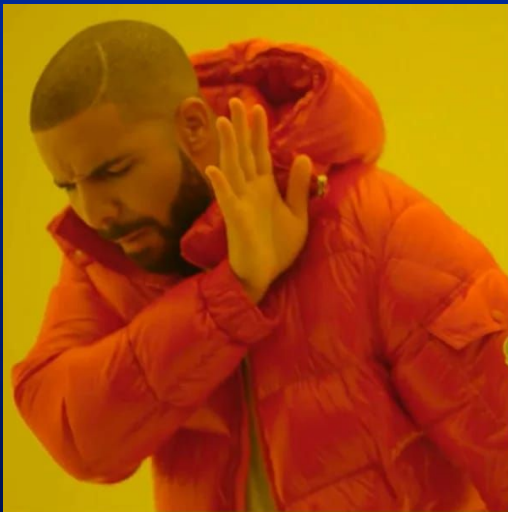
“Shadowing” + Thinking Out Loud

In professional training,
shadowing is often paired with

“Think-Aloud Protocol”
(the expert verbalizes their reasoning while performing tasks)

Transition & Knowledge Transfer





Poor Closure

- Team leaves after UAT → no training given → operations team can't maintain the system → downtime in production.



Good Closure

- Scrum team prepares clear API documentation + automated CI/CD pipeline + 2-week hypercare → smooth transition to client's IT team.

The Project Closure Checklist

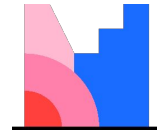
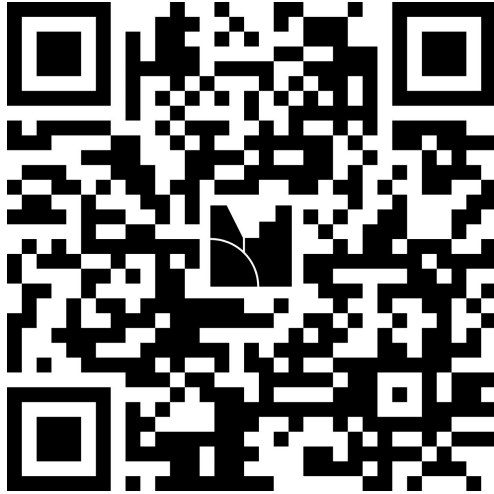
1. Planning the process
2. Deliverables
3. Documentation
4. Training
5. Communication
6. Reporting
7. Operational process
8. Maintenance and update
9. Returning resources
10. Sign off

Measuring Success at Closure

Key Metrics:

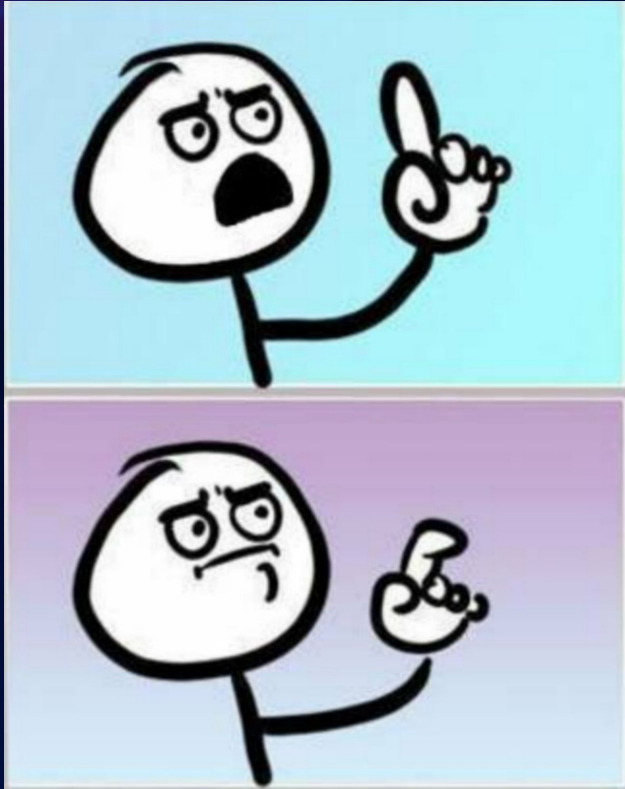
- % Deliverables accepted vs planned.
- Number of open issues/risks at closure.
- User satisfaction (survey score).
- System readiness → performance & security tests passed.
- Cost/schedule variance.

Pro Tip: Include “closure metrics” in your FYP for a professional edge.



Mentimeter

Real-World Scenario Questions: Project Handover



More Common Mistakes [To Avoid]

Scenario #1

Mistake:
Rushed handover → leads to hidden bugs.

Scenario #1

Mistake:

Rushed handover → leads to hidden bugs.

Solution:

Plan closure phase in the project schedule.

Project Management Life Cycle

Initiation &
Approval

Planning

Execution & Control

Closing

System Development Life Cycle (SDLC)

Business Requirements

System Design

Development & Unit Testing

User
Acceptance
Testing

Implementation

Project Management Life Cycle

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System Development Life Cycle (SDLC)

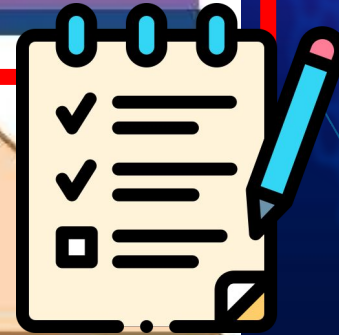
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System Design

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User
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Testing

Implementation



Scenario #2

Mistake:
Ignoring lessons learned.

Scenario #2

Mistake:
Ignoring lessons learned.

Solution:

Conduct retrospective workshops with structured formats
(e.g., Start, Stop, Continue).

Sprint Retrospectives

Start-Stop-Continue Template

Continue

What do we need to start doing?

Stop

What do we need to stop doing?

Continue

What do we need to continue doing?

Scenario #3

Mistake:
Overlooking stakeholder sign-off.

Scenario #3

Mistake:

Overlooking stakeholder sign-off.

Solution:

Always get formal acceptance
(email, form, signature).

Mentimeter

Let's go!

Conclusion

The background is a deep blue gradient. It features several abstract elements: a large, dark, wavy shape on the left side; a series of light blue hexagonal outlines forming a grid-like pattern in the upper right; and a series of light blue dots forming a wavy, ribbon-like shape in the lower right.

Key Takeaways

- Closure is as critical as coding, it defines professionalism and credibility.
- Deliverables ≠ only code → includes docs, training, lessons learned.
- Always ensure formal acceptance & handover.
- Adopt tools/templates early to avoid end-phase rush.
- Apply these principles in FYP → treat your supervisor as a “client” and deliver a professional handover package.



Kaodim!

Any questions?

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Additional resources

- <https://www.prince2.com/eur/blog/project-closure-and-handover>
 - <https://www.projectmanager.com/blog/project-closure>